



RED BANNER ALERT



mainroads
WESTERN AUSTRALIA

SHW Serious Incident (SI) – Preliminary Notice

Date of Incident:	13 September 2023	Time of Incident:	09:26
Directorate / Region:	Great Southern Region	Main Roads or Contractor:	Contractor
EQSafe Event Type:	Injury / Illness	EQSafe Incident Number:	33870
Actual Consequence:	Moderate	Potential Consequence:	Moderate

Incident Short Description:	Lower back injury during vegetation removal (LTI)
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What Happened:

At approximately 09:26 on Wednesday 13 September 2023 a contractor work team was tasked with roadside vegetation removal during inclement weather, using a chainsaw and clearing vegetation. The team had worked in multiple locations throughout the day conducting the same task.

During the task, a worker experienced severe lower back pain travelling down his leg as he made a twisting movement when lifting vegetation from the road.

Work team contacted their supervisor immediately and reported the incident. Injured person was picked up and transported to hospital for assessment/treatment; incident has been reported as a lost time injury.

An ICAM investigation has been requested. Once completed, the lessons learned will be communicated/shared through a final Grey Banner Alert as soon as possible.

Immediate Actions:

Please note that these are generic actions for all to consider in relation to this critical risk (and is not reflective of this specific incident):

- *Ensure that Workers have been trained in correct manual handling techniques.*
- *Ensure that Workers are fit for work.*
- *Conduct a risk assessment to determine where mechanical lifting devices are required and where manual handling risks can be reduced/eliminated.*

Distribution of Notice:	Main Roads Personnel and Contracting Organisations
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